

You need a team of savages.

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Aug 11, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/OYQs-tbCZSY> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Reaching \$10M/year puts you in the top 0.4% of businesses — but scaling to \$30M–\$50M requires competing against even more elite operators, making exceptional team talent the single deciding factor.

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🏆 The Elite Competition Reality at \$10M+ 0:00

- Being a **\$10M/year business** already places you in the top **0.4% of all businesses**
 - This means you are already operating in a very elite, narrow competitive tier
- Scaling to \$30M or \$50M/year means competing against people who are *even more* elite than your current competition
 - The bar doesn't stay flat — it rises sharply as you target higher revenue levels
 - You don't fully understand what it takes until you are "in the arena" competing directly with those businesses

👥 Why Team Talent Is the Deciding Factor 0:23

- When you look at why a competitor is a bigger business, it often comes down to their leadership team
 - Those teams are described as "absolute dogs" — people who are willing to work **70 hours a week**, go above and beyond, and are highly skilled in their roles
- Unless you actively elevate your team's talent and push what's possible, you cannot reach the next revenue tier
 - The insight is direct: you won't get there with an average team because your competition won't have one

"A lot of it comes down to people."

- The core takeaway: treat hiring and team-building as a competitive weapon, not just an operational necessity
 - Seek people who are intrinsically driven and willing to operate at an elite level — "savages" and "dogs" in his framing

- This mindset shift — viewing your team as the primary lever for scale — is what forces business owners to "rethink this whole game of business"